Case Scenarios

Hepatitis cases

Case 1:

A 19- year -old student who presents with a short history of abdominal discomfort and jaundice. He has associated symptoms of fatigue, decreased appetite and myalgia. He describes no change in color of his stools or urine. His abdominal discomfort is mild and left sided but is constant. There has been no recent travel abroad, he denies any drugs or recent medications. He is unaware of any family history of jaundice. On examination, he is jaundiced. No signs of chronic liver disease are seen.

Case 1:

Blood tests reveal the following:

Bilirubin 48 µmol/L D.bilirubin: 35 µmol/L

ALT 600 iU/L AST:750 Albumin 36 g/L

PC:60% PT:15 INR:1.7

Case 2:

A 25- year -old chemical engineer who presents to his general practitioner with generalized symptoms of malaise, anorexia and fever of 2 weeks. During the consultation the GP notices that he is jaundiced.

On examination, he is conscious and does not have any signs of chronic liver disease. In his abdomen his liver is palpable 2cm below the costal margin but there is no splenomegaly or ascites.

Case 2:

His blood test results:

Bilirubin 87µmol/L ALT 1842 iU/L AST 1676 iU/L Albumin 38 g/L INR 1

- *Hepatitis A IgM positive, IgG negative*
- *Hepatitis B HBsAg negative, anti-core IgM negative*
- *Hepatitis C Anti -HCV negative*

Case 3:

A 34- year -old man presents to the emergency department with a short history of jaundice and vomiting. He is otherwise fit and well with no past medical history and he takes no regular medication. Direct questioning reveals that he has never used intravenous drugs and there is no history of recent foreign travel. He got married 5 months ago and his wife is his only sexual partner.

Blood tests are as follow:

Bilirubin 127 umol/l ALT 947 iu/l INR 1

Hepatitis B surface antigen (HBs Ag) positive

Hepatitis B surface antibody (anti-HBs) negative

Hepatitis B core IgM antibody (anti-HBc) positive

Case 3:

He feels unwell for a few days but he gradually improves and 2 weeks after presentation his jaundice has completely resolved.

Blood tests taken 3 months after his initial presentation reveal:
Bilirubin 14 umol/l

ALT 42 iu/l

HBs Ag negative

Anti-HBc IgM negative

Anti-HBc IgG positive

Anti-HBs positive

Case 3:

His wife is 10 weeks' pregnant and in good health with no previous history of liver disease and undergoes blood test which reveal the following:

Bilirubin 13 umol/l ALT 27 iu/l Anti-HBe negative

Anti-HBc IgM negative Anti- HBc IgG positive

HBV DNA PCR positive HBs Ag positive

Anti-HBs negative HBe Ag positive